

How bad is AI for the environment?

Posted by u/AnnualLiterature997 • 0 points • 35 comments

I was born in one of the worst cities in America and did everything I could to move out of that place. This is relevant information because anytime something is built there, it's often times because it's the cheapest place to do so. No other reason. Many companies don't want to be there.

Elon is now building his big super computer there, which leads me think this must be extremely bad for the environment if it's being built there. That city is used as a dumping grounds by CEOs.

Comments

u/Primalturd • 1 points • 2025-07-24 02:23 UTC

Okay can someone explain *why* they're using gas turbines to power AI? I don't know much about how things are powered but If it's all computerized, then why are they using fossil fuels to power it? I always thought AI was powered by hydrogen for some reason.

u/J4ck13_ • 1 points • 2025-07-24 02:06 UTC

Obviously the electricity *could* come from renewables plus batteries and the water used *could* be as part of a closed loop heat exchange system.

u/Successful-Train-259 • 2 points • 2025-07-24 01:55 UTC

Wouldn't be as bad if we werent trying to run everything off of fucking coal power. The biggest danger of AI is how its going to be weaponized to push conspiracy theories about the climate.

u/Tranter156 • 1 points • 2025-07-24 01:52 UTC

The current data centers are huge as the Americans are using a brute force approach. The Chinese seem to be trying a more efficient approach using sparse data that doesn't use as much energy but is not quite as good. It looks like AI will get much more efficient in time. The human brain only uses 5 or 10 watts so AI has a long way to go and lots of opportunities for improvement in both function and efficiency.

u/parallax__error • 1 points • 2025-07-24 01:48 UTC

The optimistic view is that we've just started to understand what AI can do for us. And the pace of innovation is expanding at an extreme rate.

I'm in the middle of it, from a business perspective, and the result are blowing minds. Weekly.

I started off very concerned by the water and energy consumption. I'm now optimistic that we're not far from seeing AI designed climate solutions announced in a rapid manner. Like, months